

GHANA

JUNE 2015 – JULY 2026

Prepared by Africa INSIGHTS Research Team | Vertical: Travel & Tourism

Ghana holds a strong perception score of 70 but a deepening three-year slide demands urgent action on safety and hospitality.

1,094	68%	15%	17%	70/100
RECORDS IN VIEW	POSITIVE	NEUTRAL	NEGATIVE	PERCEPTION

01 MONTH IN REVIEW

Ghana's travel perception remains solidly positive — a **perception score of 70 out of 100** and a **net sentiment of 51.7** across **1,094 records** — but the direction of travel is the story. The overall score has declined steadily since 2022, and the two most structurally important themes for repeat visitation, hospitality and safety, are both measurably worsening. Scenery continues to do the heavy lifting, but it cannot indefinitely compensate for friction at ground level.

The single most consequential finding is that **hospitality negativity has risen by 14.9 points** across the period and **safety negativity has risen by 13.6 points** — both changes are large enough to qualify as signal, not noise. At the same time, transport delivers the worst net score of any reportable theme and sits well behind the peer average. These three pressures compound one another: a visitor who struggles to move around, feels less safe, and encounters more variable welcome is unlikely to become an advocate.

The one action the board should take immediately is to commission a focused qualitative audit of hospitality and safety touchpoints — particularly in Accra — and use the findings to brief operators and frontline staff before the next high-season push. Scenery alone is not a defensible positioning; Ghana's current competitive advantage in food and hospitality must be arrested from further decline before it becomes a liability.

DATA NOTE

All 1,094 records derive from YouTube comments, which means the sample captures a digitally engaged, video-inspired audience. Sentiment from offline travellers, travel-trade surveys, or review platforms is not represented and may differ materially.

DATA NOTE

The period label runs to July 2026; the 2026 annual data therefore reflects a partial year and should be read as directional rather than definitive.

02 PERCEPTION OVERVIEW

Ghana's **perception score of 70** on the 0–100 scale, where 50 is neutral, places the destination firmly in positive territory. The **net sentiment of 51.7** reinforces that reading: positive voices outweigh negative ones by a wide margin in absolute terms. The sentiment split — **68.5% positive, 14.8% neutral, 16.7% negative** — suggests a market where the majority of engaged observers are advocates or at least benign, but where the negative minority is large enough to shape the overall narrative if left unaddressed.

What the mix implies is that Ghana benefits from a strong emotional floor. The emotion data supports this: **excited** is the dominant emotional register, and **longing** is the second-most frequent. Together these two emotions account for a substantial share of the affective signal, pointing to a destination that generates aspiration as well as satisfaction. That is a meaningful asset — aspiration drives search and booking intent — but it is most valuable when the on-the-ground experience converts it into loyalty.

The **16.7% negative share** is not alarming in isolation, but in the context of a score that has fallen from **75 in 2015 to 60 in 2026**, it signals structural drift rather than random variation. The board should treat the current 70 as a rolling average that conceals a declining trajectory, not as a stable equilibrium. Protecting the score means addressing the themes that are pulling it downward, not simply amplifying the ones that are holding it up.

DATA NOTE

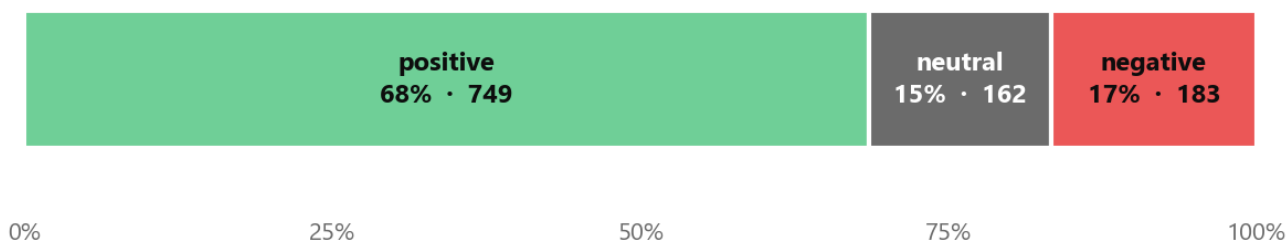
The perception score of 70 is a period aggregate. Annual scores range from a low of 57 (2016) to a high of 77 (2018), so the aggregate obscures meaningful within-period volatility.

DATA NOTE

2026 data covers a partial year only; the perception score of 60 for that year should be treated as indicative.

Figure 1 — Sentiment breakdown

How the 1,094 records in view split across sentiment classes. Net sentiment is +52 points.



03 THEMATIC ANALYSIS

Scenery is the dominant positive driver and the most-mentioned theme in the dataset, with **210 mentions and a net sentiment of 81.9** — the highest net of any reportable theme. Ghana's landscapes, coastline, and visual culture attract consistent, high-intensity praise, and this enthusiasm is well captured in the voices on record. The comment from @folarinosibodu (Oct 2020), praising authentic village visits over "high-end pretentious restaurants," illustrates that for many viewers the appeal is precisely Ghana's unpolished, lived-in beauty rather than curated tourist product. That is a positioning strength, but it also means the destination's top asset depends on real-world authenticity being maintained — a point planners should factor into development decisions around coastal and village sites.

Food and hospitality both deliver positive nets — **57.1 and 39.4** respectively — and both sit ahead of the peer average by reportable margins. These are competitive advantages worth protecting and promoting. However, hospitality carries a shadow: **26.1% of its mentions are negative**, and its negativity rate has risen by **14.9 points** across the period, the largest reportable deterioration of any theme. The dynamic is captured neatly, if ironically, by @ericoteng7898 (Dec 2020): "if they realise you're a foreigner, the way they'll treat you, I swear you won't return to your country again" — a comment intended as a compliment, but one that also signals a perceived two-tier experience that some visitors register as pressure rather than warmth. Managing the line between enthusiastic welcome and commercial solicitation is a training and messaging challenge the board cannot defer.

Safety returns a **net of 8.8**, which is positive in aggregate and ahead of peers, but the direction is the concern: negativity has risen by **13.6 points** and now stands at **40.4%** of safety mentions. Nearly half the safety conversation is unfavourable. At present Ghana still outperforms its peer average on safety net sentiment, but that advantage is narrowing, and if the trajectory continues the lead will be erased within the forecast horizon. Transport is the most structurally negative reportable theme, with a **net of -13.8** and **41.4% negative mentions**, and it sits behind peers by a gap of **15.9 points** — the largest competitive deficit of any reportable theme. Cost also records a negative net of **-18.8**, with **50.0% of its mentions negative**; @Allrightguy83 (Nov 2021) reflects an ambivalent position on pricing — personally willing to pay, but noting the market dynamic in a way that frames value as a live issue for arriving visitors.

DATA NOTE

Four themes — weather, electricity, water, and wildlife — fall below the 15-mention minimum and are excluded from headline findings. Electricity shows a worsening trend in the movement data but cannot be reported as a finding at current sample size.

DATA NOTE

The food theme's movement data (improving by 39.3 points) is not reportable due to thin sub-period samples; the improvement is noted as indicative only.

DATA NOTE

Cost movement (worsening by 38.1 points) is also not reportable at current sample size.

Voices behind the numbers

The most-engaged supportive and critical mentions in this view. Emoji and non-Latin characters are stripped for print.

POSITIVE · @WODEMAYA · Dec 2020 · 6,368 likes · score +0.29

"Lmaooo why I kept say Tik Tok??Welcome to Ghana man!"

POSITIVE · @folarinosibodu · Oct 2020 · 2,016 likes · score +0.75

"Mark really knows how to embed himself and let the culture transform him. Using his hands...that's exactly how to do it. He is so humble. He visits villages, instead of high-end pretentious restaurants. He really gets to the authentic nature of how to eat the foods. Very impressive."

NEGATIVE · @KwekuTed · Dec 2022 · 2,245 likes · score -0.48

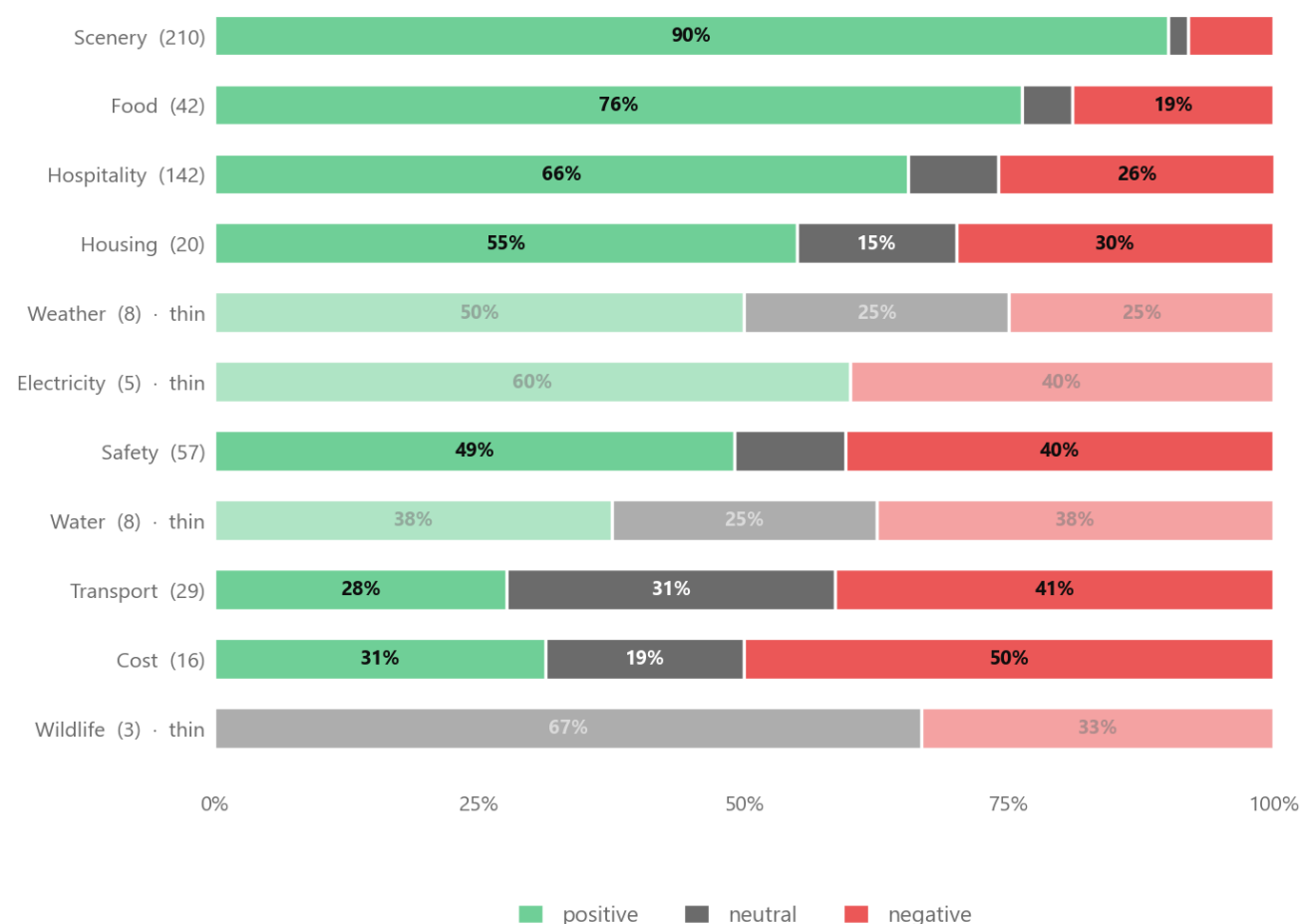
"I'm Ghanaian, I live in the capital city away from the parts shown initially in the video. Those parts are huge slums, situated along the coast (Jamestown, korle and Bukom). They are some of the oldest townships in the Capital, towns that initially sprung up with the arrival of the British (traders..."

NEGATIVE · @Allrightguy83 · Nov 2021 · 389 likes · score -0.06

"I was in Ghana last summer for two weeks and had the best time of my life. So, I'm just gonna put it out there...when I was in the markets and someone wanted to sell me a bracelet for 50 cedis, or about eight bucks, did I sweat it and say, hey I'll give you 25? Hell no. I gave him or her the 50 cedis..."

Figure 2 — Sentiment by theme

Every travel theme mentioned in this view, ranked by net sentiment. Mention counts in brackets; themes below the 15-mention floor are faded and marked thin.



04 VISITOR SEGMENTS

The segment data captures adventure, budget, business, and luxury travellers, and the directional spread is worth noting for planning purposes. Adventure visitors register the highest perception score and net sentiment among the four cohorts, while business visitors are the only cohort in negative net sentiment territory. Budget visitors sit between the two on most measures, and luxury visitors record a moderately positive score.

However, **none of the four cohorts clears the 50-record minimum threshold** required for reportable findings. Only **4.2% of records** are segment-classified, leaving the overwhelming majority unclassified. No cohort-to-cohort comparison can be made with analytical confidence, and no segment-specific finding should anchor a budget or messaging decision at this stage. The directional patterns are consistent with what destination managers would expect — business travellers are most exposed to transport and cost friction, adventure visitors are most likely to praise scenery — but these are hypotheses to test, not conclusions to act on.

The strategic implication is that segment intelligence is currently a gap in Ghana's perception data. The board should prioritise data collection that tags visitor type at the point of content creation or survey — through structured partnerships with travel creators, post-trip surveys distributed via accommodation providers, or tagged review prompts — so that future reports can make the cohort comparisons this one cannot.

DATA NOTE

No visitor segment cohort meets the 50-record minimum threshold. All segment figures in the fact pack are indicative only and may not be cited as reportable findings or used to rank cohorts against one another.

DATA NOTE

Only 4.2% of the 1,094 records carry a segment classification, meaning the classified sample is not representative of the full visitor population observed in this dataset.

VISITOR SEGMENT	RECORDS	SHARE OF VIEW	PERCEPTION	NET
Adventure · thin	15	1.4%	74/100	+60
Budget · thin	13	1.2%	56/100	+23
Business · thin	12	1.1%	46/100	-8
Luxury · thin	6	0.5%	57/100	+33

05 COMPETITIVE BENCHMARKING

Ghana ranks **second out of ten reportable peers** with a perception score of **70**, sitting **3 points behind leader Tanzania** (73) and level with Rwanda and Senegal. That is a strong structural position: Ghana outscores Kenya (69), Zimbabwe (68), South Africa (65), Egypt (64), Nigeria (62), and Morocco (39). The gap to Tanzania is within reach but would require reversing the current declining trend rather than simply holding position. The gap to the bottom of the peer group is wide enough that near-term competitive risk does not come from being overtaken — it comes from the internal trajectory eroding Ghana's lead over the middle-ranking peers.

On food, Ghana holds a **17.3-point advantage** over the peer net — the largest positive gap of any reportable theme — and on hospitality the lead is **17.0 points** ahead of peers. These are differentiating strengths that current marketing materials should foreground explicitly. On safety, Ghana is **13.9 points ahead** of the peer average, a meaningful edge given that safety is a primary consideration for first-time visitors to the region. These three advantages — food, hospitality, and relative safety — constitute a coherent and distinctive positioning: a

welcoming, flavourful destination that feels more accessible than regional alternatives.

Transport is Ghana's sharpest competitive liability. The country's transport net of **-13.8** sits **15.9 points behind the peer average** of 2.1 — the only reportable theme where Ghana lags peers by a gap that clears the 10-point materiality threshold on the negative side. Peers are, on balance, generating slightly positive transport sentiment while Ghana generates clearly negative sentiment. This gap is operationally significant: transport friction at scale suppresses the conversion of positive first impressions into return visits and recommendations, and it undermines the food and hospitality advantages that Ghana otherwise holds.

DATA NOTE

Cameroon does not meet the 50-record minimum and is excluded from all comparative findings; it appears in the peer list but is not ranked.

DATA NOTE

The benchmark peer average figures cited are drawn directly from the fact pack's aspect_gaps data and reflect the mean across the nine reportable peers, not Ghana itself.

DATA NOTE

Morocco's reportable perception score of 39 and negative net sentiment are notably out of step with the rest of the peer group; its inclusion in averages may warrant review by the research team.

MARKET	RECORDS	PERCEPTION	NET SENTIMENT
Tanzania	1,326	73/100	+59
Ghana	1,094	70/100	+52
Rwanda	1,526	70/100	+54
Senegal	1,114	70/100	+50
Kenya	2,075	69/100	+52
Zimbabwe	1,186	68/100	+50
South Africa	2,164	65/100	+39
Egypt	2,305	64/100	+36
Nigeria	1,884	62/100	+33
Morocco	52	39/100	-21

06 TRENDS & SIGNALS

The long-run trend is a declining one. Ghana's perception score has fallen from **75 in 2015 to 60 in 2026**, a **decline of 15 points** across the period. The fall is not linear — scores peaked at **77 in 2018** and recovered to **76 in 2022** after a pandemic dip — but the post-2022 direction is consistently downward: **70 in 2023, 68 in 2024, 67 in 2025, and 60 in 2026**. The acceleration of decline in the most recent periods, combined with a rising negative share (reaching **25.9%** in 2026), is the clearest signal in the dataset. This is not drift; it is a trend with momentum.

At the theme level, the two reportable worsening signals are hospitality and safety. Hospitality negativity has risen by **14.9 points** between the first and second halves of the period — a change that clears the trend threshold comfortably — and safety negativity has risen by **13.6 points**. Scenery, Ghana's strongest theme, is also showing a worsening signal of **9.2 points** in its negativity rate. While scenery's overall net remains very high

at 81.9, any erosion of the destination's anchor asset deserves monitoring and should not be dismissed as noise. Food is the one reportable theme moving in the right direction, though its movement data does not reach the reportable threshold and should be treated as indicative.

The combination of a falling overall score, rising negativity on the three themes that matter most for word-of-mouth (hospitality, safety, and scenery), and a competitive environment where peers are stable or improving means Ghana is slowly ceding relative ground. The 2026 partial-year score of 60 — the lowest in the dataset — should be treated as an early warning. If the pattern holds into the full year, Ghana risks slipping below 65 and out of its current top-two position in the peer ranking.

DATA NOTE

2026 data reflects a partial year. The perception score of 60 and negative share of 25.9% for that year are directional indicators, not full-year figures.

DATA NOTE

Early years in the trend (2015–2017) have thin annual samples (12, 13, and 30 records respectively) and their year-on-year movements should be read with caution. The period from 2018 onward, where annual records are consistently above 85, carries greater analytical weight.

DATA NOTE

Food and cost movement data do not meet the reportable threshold despite showing large directional changes; these are noted as indicative only.

Figure 3 — Perception over time (by year)

Perception score per period on a 0–100 scale, where 50 is neutral.

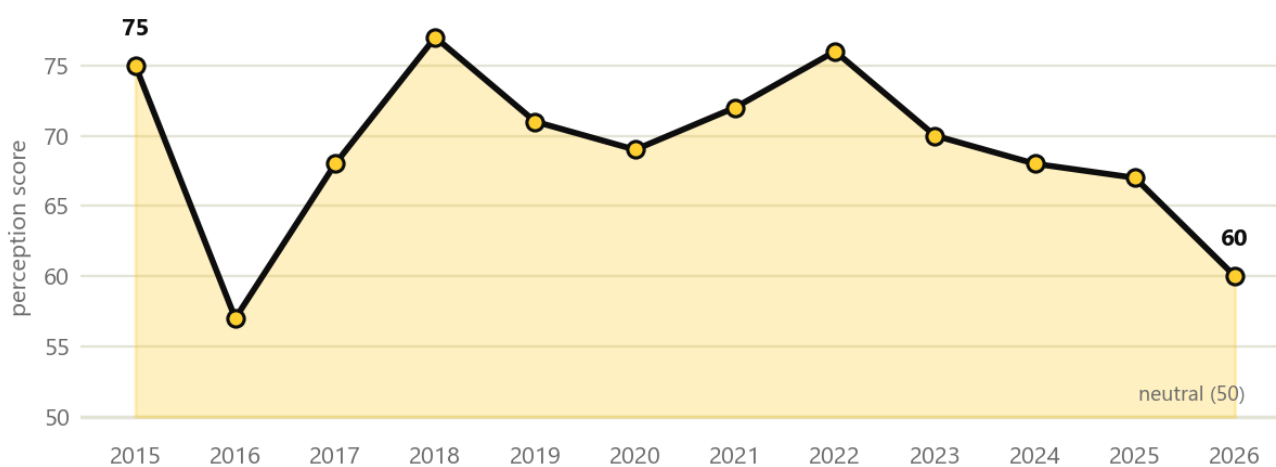
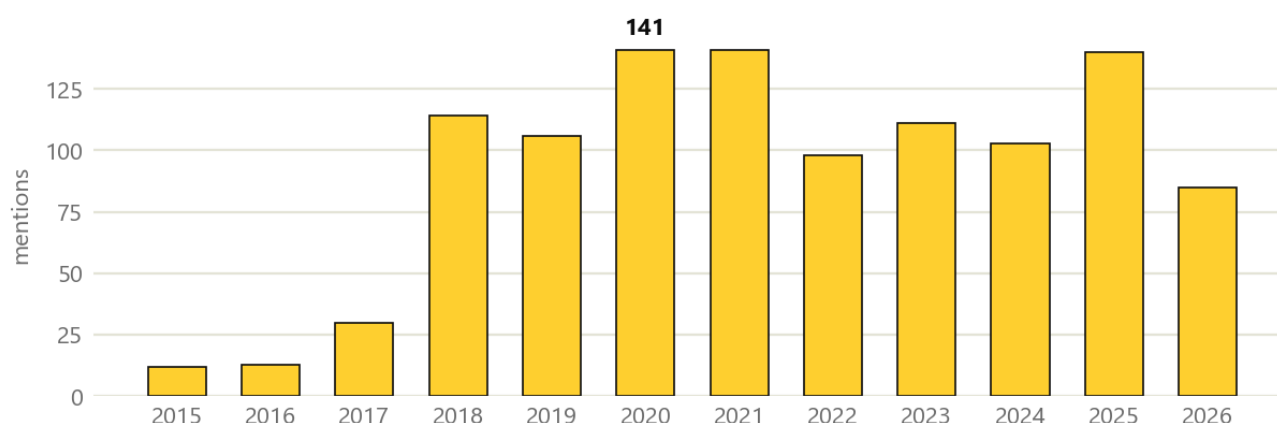


Figure 4 — Conversation volume (by year)

Records per period. Read the trend above against this: a swing on thin volume is noise.



07 RECOMMENDATIONS

The most urgent intervention is a structured hospitality quality programme targeted at operators and frontline staff in Accra and major visitor-facing locations. The trigger is the **14.9-point rise in hospitality negativity** across the period — the largest reportable thematic deterioration — combined with a **17.0-point lead over peers** that is actively narrowing. Ghana's hospitality advantage is one of only two themes where it differentiates clearly from the peer group; losing it would remove a core marketing claim. The action is to partner with the Ghana Tourism Authority and hotel and hospitality associations to deploy a service-standards training cycle, with particular focus on managing the foreigner-pricing dynamic that voices like @ericoteng7898 (Dec 2020) and @Allrightguy83 (Nov 2021) both flag, albeit from different directions. The target audience is tour operators, market vendors, accommodation staff, and transport providers at the most visited sites.

The second priority is closing the transport gap. Ghana's transport net of **-13.8** sits **15.9 points behind the peer average** — the only reportable competitive deficit of this magnitude. The action is twofold: first, the board should engage the Ministry of Roads and Transport with this benchmarked gap as evidence for prioritising visitor-facing infrastructure improvements; second, the destination marketing communications should actively signpost reliable transport options (airport transfers, trusted ride-hailing services, inter-city coaches) in pre-arrival content. The target audience is prospective visitors in planning mode — particularly those who engage with travel video content, given that the entire dataset derives from that channel.

Safety sentiment, while still ahead of peers, has deteriorated by **13.6 points** and now shows **40.4% negative** mentions. The board should work with the Ghana Police Service and tourism security units to increase visible presence at heritage sites, markets, and coastal areas that feature prominently in travel video content. Communications targeting diaspora and first-time African-heritage visitors — a group strongly represented in the YouTube comment sentiment — should explicitly address safety with factual, specific reassurance rather than generic messaging. Finally, the segment classification gap is a data infrastructure problem with a direct strategic cost: the board should fund a structured post-trip survey mechanism to generate cohort-level data, so the next planning cycle can allocate spend by visitor type rather than across an undifferentiated audience.

DATA NOTE

Segment-specific recommendations cannot be made with confidence at this time because no visitor cohort meets the 50-record reporting threshold. The recommendation to build segment data infrastructure is itself triggered by this gap.

DATA NOTE

The recommendation on safety communications referencing diaspora and heritage visitors is directional, based on the observable character of YouTube comment voices in the dataset, and not derived from a reportable demographic breakdown.

08 METHODOLOGY & PROVENANCE

Country	Ghana
Year range	2015–2026
Aspect (any of)	all aspects
Sentiment	positive, neutral, negative
Data source	all
Relevant records only	yes
Period	June 2015 – July 2026
Records	1,094
Generated	19 Aug 2026 12:22 UTC
Narrative	Written by claude-sonnet-4-6; every figure verified against the computed data.

Evidence base: 1,094 YouTube comments. 94% of records were attributed to this market from what the text itself is about rather than from the query that surfaced them. Sentiment is scored by a multilingual transformer; themes, emotion and visitor segment are rule-based taggers. Evidence thresholds: 50 records for a reliable view, 15 mentions before a theme can headline a finding, 5 points before a theme counts as praised or criticised, 10 points before a cross-country gap is stated. Every figure in this report is computed from the filtered records by the analysis pipeline. The written analysis interprets those figures; each number it states is verified back against them before publication, and any section that fails verification is replaced by the deterministic summary.